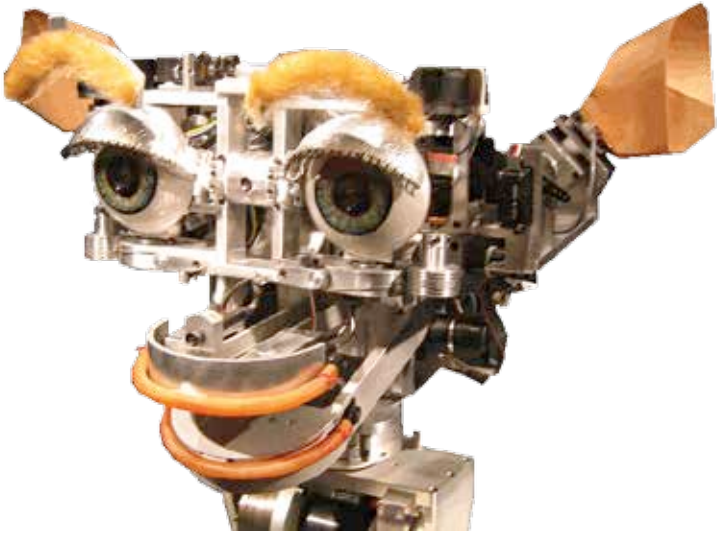


Source:Wikimedia



Kismet is a robot at MIT's AI lab that can interpret human body language and inflection of voice in language.

Here, one transcends from the buzzword of the 2000's - machine learning - to the buzzword of the 21st century - 'artificial intelligence'. We are gradually expanding our field of concern from getting good at specific tasks, like identifying good oranges from bad ones, to extremely general, subtle and nuanced problems - speech recognition, noise elimination, audio labelling, body-language parsing, and natural language processing. A classic problem in Artificial Intelligence is to adapt a gained intelligence (or set of parameters, to a computer) to a new form of intelligence, or even to choose better kinds of parameters for existing as well as new kinds of intelligence. Consider a child who has learnt to play table tennis, and wishes to learn tennis - he doesn't start from scratch! Skillsets from his past experiences will aid his picking up of a new skill. A similar concept is being implemented in the realm of artificial intelligence, besides a host of other techniques, to produce remarkably human-like, nuanced and subtle behaviours.

What the future holds - can robots be dangerous?

Everyone's heard the stories. If it's Stephen Hawking today, it's Bill Gates tomorrow, and Elon Musk the day after - all warning us about the potency of machines that can learn and make decisions independently from human